

01

REASON, REVELATION AND FAITH: THE BASIC PROBLEM

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Reason appeals to publicly assessable inference, revelation to purported divine disclosure, and faith to committed assent or trust that may exceed demonstration.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Religious systems combine rational preambles, claims of disclosure and acts of trust in different proportions to justify belief and practice.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Different weightings produce rationalism, compatibilism, critical faith and fideism, each with a distinct burden of proof.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Do not equate faith with unsupported belief or revelation with a self-authenticating proof available to every observer.

ANSWER LINE: The philosophical problem is not whether religion uses only one source, but how rational inquiry, disclosed authority and committed trust can coexist without contradiction or arbitrariness.

02

REASON, NATURAL THEOLOGY AND RATIONAL JUSTIFICATION

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Role (2024 PYQ): reason (a) constructs natural theology (proofs for God), (b) tests coherence of doctrines, (c) interprets scripture, (d) defends faith (apologetics). □ Rationalism: religious beliefs must meet the bar of reason/evidence (Clifford: "it is wrong always... to believe anything upon insufficient evidence"). □ Limits: proofs are inconclusive (see Proofs note); the transcendent may exceed reason → space for revelation & faith. □□ Rational vs irrational aspects of faith (2023): faith has a rational side (grounds, coherence, cumulative evidence) and a supra-/non-rational side (trust, commitment, the leap beyond proof). □□.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The operative mechanism is that reason (a) constructs natural theology (proofs for God), (b) tests coherence of doctrines, (c)...

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

The resulting consequence is that reason (a) constructs natural theology (proofs for God), (b) tests coherence of doctrines, (c)...

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Do not miss this limiting distinction: reason (a) constructs natural theology (proofs for God), (b) tests coherence of doctrines, (c)...

ANSWER LINE: Role (2024 PYQ): reason (a) constructs natural theology (proofs for God), (b) tests coherence of doctrines, (c) interprets scripture, (d) defends faith (apologetics). □ Rationalism: religious beliefs must meet the bar of reason/evidence (Clifford: "it is wrong always... to believe anything upon insufficient evidence"). □ Limits: proofs are inconclusive (see Proofs note); the transcendent may exceed reason → space for revelation & faith. □□ Rational vs irrational aspects of faith (2023): faith has a rational side (grounds, coherence, cumulative evidence) and a supra-/non-rational side (trust, commitment, the leap beyond proof). □□.

03

REVELATION, AUTHORITY AND DISCLOSURE

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[!IMPORTANT] Revelation is an alleged divine self-disclosure that supplies truth or presence unavailable to unaided reason.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Final verdict: A revelation claim becomes philosophically credible only when disclosure, interpretation and public criteria are kept distinct.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Non-propositional view (Hick): revelation is God's acts/self-presence in history & experience, humanly interpreted — not a set of dictated propositions.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Do not miss this limiting distinction: epistemic justification of revelation (2024 PYQ).

ANSWER LINE: Revelation is an alleged divine self-disclosure that supplies truth or presence unavailable to unaided reason.

04

FAITH, BELIEF, TRUST AND COMMITMENT

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Final verdict: Faith is rationally responsible when it transcends evidence without violating coherence or ignoring defeaters.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Core argument/criticism: Aquinas explains faith as intellectual assent commanded by the will, while Kierkegaard stresses passionate commitment under objective uncertainty.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

This reconciles reason & faith — reason establishes the "preambles" (God exists), faith accepts the "mysteries" (Trinity) that exceed but don't contradict reason. □ Kierkegaard — faith as the LEAP: faith is a passionate, subjective commitment in "objective uncertainty"; the leap of faith transcends reason (Abraham's "teleological suspension of the ethical").

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Do not miss this limiting distinction: faith is rationally responsible when it transcends evidence without violating coherence or ignoring defeaters.

ANSWER LINE: Faith is firm trust and commitment that goes beyond conclusive proof without necessarily opposing reason.

05

COMPATIBILISM, FIDEISM AND RIVAL STANCES

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Final verdict: Aquinas offers the most balanced model when reason establishes preambles and faith assents to mysteries that exceed but do not contradict reason.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Final verdict: Aquinas offers the most balanced model when reason establishes preambles and faith assents to mysteries that exceed but do not contradict reason.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

The resulting consequence is that reason & revelation cannot conflict (both from God).

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Do not miss this limiting distinction: aquinas offers the most balanced model when reason establishes preambles and faith assents to...

ANSWER LINE: □ Aquinas is the balanced default: reason & revelation cannot conflict (both from God); reason proves the preambles, revelation supplies the mysteries; faith is intellectual assent under grace.

06

AQUINAS, KIERKEGAARD AND FOUNDATIONAL POSITIONS

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[Aquinas] "How does Aquinas' faith-as-'intellectual assent' reconcile reason & faith?" (2025) → §3. [Reason] "Role of reason in religion." (2024) → §1. [Revelation] "Distinguish natural & revealed theology (propositional view)." (2025) → §2. [Justification] "Epistemic justifications of revelation-claims." (2024) → §2. [Faith-revelation] "Is faith indispensable for revelation?" (2022) → §3. [Science] "Significance of religion vis-à-vis present scientific and technological development." (2020, 10m) → §9.6 — Barbour's four models, not a Galileo narrative. [Faith/belief] "Basic tenets of faith; distinguish faith and belief." (2020, 15m) → §9.7 — enumerate the seven tenets, then the five axes. [Justification] "Can religious beliefs be justified?" (2023, 10m) → §9.9 — evidentialism vs Reformed epistemology; add the svatah/paratah-prāmānya mapping. [Reason regulative] "Can reason be a regulative force in forming religious beliefs?" (2021, 20m) → §1 + §9.1 + §9.9 — regulative ≠ constitutive; reason can veto and discipline without generating. [Rational/irrational] "Rational and irrational aspects of faith." (2023, 15m) → §9.5 — insist on supra-rational as a third category. [Miracles] "Can testimony establish a miracle?" → §9.8.

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

The resulting consequence is that □ The Augustinian–Anselmian formula credo ut intelligam presents faith as seeking understanding. □ Aquinas...

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Do not miss this limiting distinction: □ The Augustinian–Anselmian formula credo ut intelligam presents faith as seeking understanding. □ Aquinas...

ANSWER LINE: □ The Augustinian–Anselmian formula credo ut intelligam presents faith as seeking understanding. □ Aquinas places faith between demonstrative knowledge and wavering opinion: it is firm assent to what is not seen. □ Kierkegaard links faith with passionate inward commitment under objective uncertainty. □ Clifford's evidentialist maxim makes insufficient evidence morally relevant to belief. □ The popular formula credo quia absurdum is commonly associated with Tertullian but is not a safe verbatim quotation from him; use it only as a later slogan for extreme fideism.

07

INDIAN AND WESTERN MODELS OF REASONED FAITH

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Core argument/criticism: Mīmāṃsā (Vedic exegesis) defends authorless scripture and intrinsic validity, while Nyāya (logic and realist epistemology) requires externally confirmed credibility.

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

The resulting consequence is that mīmāṃsā (Vedic exegesis) defends authorless scripture and intrinsic validity.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Do not miss this limiting distinction: mīmāṃsā (Vedic exegesis) defends authorless scripture and intrinsic validity.

ANSWER LINE: Indian epistemology reframes reason and revelation through pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge), especially śabda (verbal testimony).